



call, each villa comes with its own bicycles to navigate the island.

Mornings begin with the crunch of tires on sand as you head toward Claudine, the Mediterranean restaurant for breakfast. The service is intuitive; a chilled coconut appears when humidity peaks, a sangria when the sun finally dips. While the island offers world-class surfing, snorkelling and diving, the best thing to do here is nothing at all. I spent my days cycling to beaches where the only footprint was my own. Lunch was from a food truck, eaten from a hammock slung between palms. You can also spend time scratching the leathery necks of giant Aldabra tortoises. Desroches is home to more than 150 of these and you'll see them everywhere—grazing under papaya trees and frequently causing the island's only traffic jams. There is a sanctuary for the juveniles, but the adults, like George, who is reportedly 130 years old, roam with the same absolute freedom as do the guests here.

A Movable Feast

For a resort anchored 230 kilometres from the mainland, the culinary programme at Four Seasons is remarkable. The menu shifts based on the morning catch and the daily harvest from its own organic gardens. The range is impressive, moving from local Creole specialities like octopus curry to perfectly blistered pizzas, delicately packed sushi, and premium dry-aged meats. But it is the settings that takes your breath away. You can dine on the sand under swaying palms, on the jetty with the waves for company, or inside the historic Lighthouse while the sky puts on its most brilliant evening performance. But the real theatre begins after dark when the private airstrip transforms into a vast, open-air observatory. With zero light pollution, the tarmac offers front-row seats to a sky so crowded with stars, it feels close enough to touch. This, I suspect, is why the royals and the glitterati fly this far. It's not just about the anonymity, but the realisation that sometimes the punctuation is the xx.